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Ram Mandir

The **Ram Mandir** (ISO: *Rāma Maṁdira*, lit. 'Rama Temple'), is a Hindu temple complex in Ayodhya,[a] Uttar Pradesh, India.[6][7] Many Hindus believe that it is located at the site of Ram Janmabhoomi, the mythical birthplace of Rama, a principal deity of Hinduism.[8][9]

The temple was inaugurated on 22 January 2024 in an elaborate ceremony led by Indian Prime Minister Modi, in which the Hindu priests performed religious rituals for *prāṇa pratiṣṭhā* (transl. consecration) of the deity.[7][6][10] On the first day of its opening, the temple received a rush of over half a million visitors.[11] The temple has a high number of daily visitors reportedly between 100,000 and 150,000.[12] Ram Mandir become Uttar Pradesh state's top religious tourism destination drawing over 135.5 million visitors in 2024.[13] The temple construction was completed on 25 November 2025 with an event marked by hoisting of the *Dharma Dhwaja* (sacred flag).[14]

The site of the temple had been the subject of communal tensions between Hindus and Muslims in India, as it was the former location of Babri Masjid, built around 1528. In the 1850s, a fence was erected and Hindus were allowed to worship in the outer courtyard.[15] In 1949, the *Murti* (transl. sacred idol) of Rama was placed inside the fence.[15] In 1980s, a campaign was launched by Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) to claim the site for Hindus[15], which led to the structure being attacked and demolished in 1992.[16][17][18] In 2019, the Supreme Court of India delivered the verdict to give the disputed land to Hindus for construction of a temple, while Muslims were given land nearby to construct a mosque.[19] The court referenced a report from the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) as evidence of a non-Islamic structure beneath the demolished Babri Masjid.[20]

Ram Mandir

Rāma Maṁdira

Ram Mandir in 2025

Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
District	Ayodhya district
Deity	*Balak Ram (idol)* (infant form of Rama)
Governing body	Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra
Status	▪ Completed, 25 November 2025 ▪ (consecrated 22 January 2024[1])

Location	
Location	Ayodhya[a]
State	Uttar Pradesh
Country	India

Interactive map of Ram Mandir

On 5 August 2020, the *bhūmi pūjana* (trans. ground breaking ceremony) for the commencement of the construction of Ram Mandir was performed by PM Modi.[21] The temple construction was supervised by the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust. On 22 January 2024, Modi served as the *Mukhya Yajamāna* (trans. chief patron) of rituals for the event and performed the *prāṇa pratiṣṭhā* (trans. consecration) of the temple.[22][23] The *prana pratishtha* ceremony was held in the *garbhagriha* (sanctum sanctorum) where the infant form of Rama deity, referred as *Ram Lalla* (lit. 'Child Rama') was sanctified and worshipped with religious rituals.[24][25][26]

Coordinates	26.7956°N 82.1943°E
Architecture	
Architect	Sompura family[b]
Style	Maru-Gurjara architecture
Groundbreaking	5 August 2020[4]
Specifications	
Length	110 metres (360 ft)
Width	72 metres (235 ft)
Height (max)	49 metres (161 ft)[5]
Site area	1.1 hectares (2.7 acres)[5]

The temple is designed in the Nagara style of Hindu temple architecture.[27] The temple's main structure includes *garbha griha* (sanctum sanctorum) and five *mandapas* (domes), with shikharas (towers).[24][28] The presiding deity, Ram Lalla is centrally located in the sanctum sanctorum, on the ground floor, while the first floor houses the Ram Darbar, including Ram, Sita, Lakshman, and Hanuman.[29] The temple complex includes six smaller temples of Surya (Sun), Goddess Durga (Bhagwati), Ganesh, and Shiva at its four corners, while Maa Annapurna and Hanuman temples are on its the northern and southern sides.[29][30]

Background

Significance of Rama

Rama is a prominent Hindu deity who is regarded as a *Pūrṇāvatāra* (lit. 'complete avatar') of the God Vishnu.[c] Some Hindus view Rama as Para Brahman (lit. 'The ultimate Brahman'). Rama holds immense significance in Hinduism. According to Hindu mythology, the Rama avatar is not supposed to exhibit any of Vishnu's divine potencies, and he leads his life as a human.[32] As Rama is said to have possessed sixteen ideal qualities, Hindus view Rama as *Puruṣottama* (lit. 'Ideal man'), *Vigrahavān dharmaḥ* (lit. 'Embodiment of Dharma'), and *Ādi Puruṣa* (lit. 'First man' or 'Primordial being').[33][34][d] According to the Hindu epic *Ramayana*, Rama was born in a mythical city named Ayodhya.[35] The present-day city of Ayodhya, which emerged in the second century CE, is a separate settlement and not the same as the Hindu mythical city of the same name.[36][37] Present-day Ayodhya was named "Saketa" until it was renamed in the fifth century CE by a king of the Gupta Empire who wished to associate himself with the mythical birthplace of Rama.[38]

Deity

The Ram Mandir is being built to commemorate the birth of Rama: therefore, the presiding deity of the temple is supposed to be the infant form of Rama, an avatar of Vishnu. Rama in that infant form was referred as *Ram Lalla* (lit. 'Child Rama') by Tulsidas. However, the idol of Rama that was placed in 1949 referred to as *Ram Lalla Virajman* (lit. 'Installed Child Rama') by local Hindus.[39] *Ram Lalla* was a

litigant in the court case over the disputed site in 1989, being considered a "juristic person" by the law.[3] He was represented by Triloki Nath Pandey, a senior VHP leader who was considered *Ram Lalla*'s closest 'human' friend.[39] As a new idol of the deity got installed in the sanctum sanctorum as the *Mūlavirāt mūrti* (lit. The main presiding deity),[e] the Mandir Trust has informed that the *Ram Lalla Virajman* idol of 1949 shall henceforth be used as *Utsava mūrti* (lit. idol for festivals).[42]

Ram Lalla, the five-year old form of Rama is the principal deity of the Ram Mandir.

History

The site is the former location of the Babri Masjid, which was built in the 16th century. The mosque was attacked and demolished in 1992.[16][17][18] In 2019, the Supreme Court of India delivered the verdict to give the disputed land to Hindus for the construction of a temple, while Muslims would be given land elsewhere to construct a mosque.[43]

Medieval

In 1528, a commander of the Mughal Empire, Mir Baqi, constructed the Babri Masjid mosque, under the order of Babur. The site chosen for the mosque is identified by many Hindus as Ram Janmabhoomi, the mythical birthplace of Rama.[44] The earliest record of the mosque may be traced back to 1767, in the Latin book *Descriptio Indiae*, authored by the Jesuit missionary Joseph Tiefenthaler. According to him, the local population believed that the mosque was constructed by destroying the Ramkot temple, believed to be the fortress of Rama in Ayodhya, and the Bedi, where the birthplace of Rama is situated.[45][46]

Modern

Disputed location

The first instance of religious violence was documented in 1853.[15] In December 1858, the British administration prohibited Hindus from conducting *puja* (rituals) at the contested site. A platform was created for conducting rituals outside the mosque.[47]

Ram Mandir in 2024

Murtis (trans. sacred idols) of Rama and Sita were installed inside the Babri Masjid on the night of 22–23 December 1949, after which devotees began visiting the site.[16][48] By 1950, the state took control of the mosque under Section 145 CrPC and allowed Hindus, not Muslims, to perform their worship at the site.[49]

In the 1980s, the Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP), belonging to the Hindu nationalist family, Sangh Parivar, launched a new movement to reclaim the site for Hindus and to erect a temple dedicated to the infant Rama (*Ram Lalla*) at this spot. The VHP began to collect funds and bricks with "Jai Shri Ram" written on them. Later, the government under Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi gave the VHP permission for *Shilanyas* (transl. the foundation stone ceremony) to proceed, with the then Home Minister, Buta Singh, formally conveying the permission to the VHP leader, Ashok Singhal. Initially, the Government of India and the Government of Uttar Pradesh had agreed that the *shilanya*s would be conducted outside of the disputed site. However, on 9 November 1989, a group of VHP leaders and Sadhus laid the foundation stone by digging a 200-litre (7-cubic-foot) pit adjacent to the disputed land. The *singhdwar* (transl. main entrance) of the sanctum sanctorum was constructed there.[50] The VHP then laid the foundations of a temple on the land adjacent to the disputed mosque.

Demolition of the Babri Masjid

On 6 December 1992, the VHP and the Bharatiya Janata Party organised a rally at the site involving 150,000 volunteers, known as karsevaks. The rally turned violent, the crowd overwhelmed the security forces and tore down the mosque.[51][52]

The demolition of the mosque resulted in several months of inter-communal violence between India's Hindu and Muslim communities, causing the death of an estimated 2,000 people in Bombay (now Mumbai) as a direct consequence, and triggering riots all over the Indian subcontinent.[53] A day after the demolition of the mosque, on 7 December 1992, *The New York Times* reported that over 30 Hindu temples across Pakistan were attacked, some set on fire, and one was demolished. Hindu temples in Bangladesh were also attacked.[51]

On 5 July 2005, five terrorists attacked the makeshift Ram temple at the site of the destroyed Babri Masjid in Ayodhya. All five were shot dead in the ensuing encounter with the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF), while one civilian died in the grenade attack that the attackers launched to breach the cordoned wall. The CRPF suffered three casualties, two of whom were seriously injured with multiple gunshot wounds.[54][55]

ASI excavations

Reports on two archaeological excavations in 1978 and 2003 conducted by the ASI claimed to have found evidence indicating that a temple existed on the site.[56][57] The claims were heavily disputed by critics as contradictory and unreliable.[58][59][60][61][62] Archaeologist K. K. Muhammed maintained that remains of a Hindu temple were found in 1978, and accused several historians of averting a settlement for the dispute.[63]

Court rulings

Over the years, various title and legal disputes took place, such as the passage of the Acquisition of Certain Areas at Ayodhya Act in 1993. In 2010, the Allahabad High Court ruled that the 1.12 hectares (2.77 acres) of disputed land be divided into three parts, one going to the Ram Lalla or Infant Rama, represented by the Hindu Mahasabha for the construction of the Ram temple, one going to the Muslim Sunni Waqf Board, and one going to Hindu religious denomination Nirmohi Akhara.[8][64] All three parties involved appealed against the division of disputed land to the Supreme Court.[65][66]

In the Supreme Court's verdict on the Ayodhya dispute in 2019, it was decided that the disputed land would be handed over to a trust formed by the Government of India for the construction of a Ram temple.[67][68]

The court referenced the 2003 report from the ASI, as evidence suggesting the presence of a structure beneath the demolished Babri Masjid, that was found to be non-Islamic.[69][70] The Supreme Court, in its landmark judgement concluded that the underlying structure beneath the mosque was not an Islamic structure, and also concluded that no evidence was found that a non-Islamic structure was specifically demolished for the construction of the Babri Masjid.[70][71] Another salient aspect in the apex court's judgement is on the question on the claim of Hindus that disputed structure as the birthplace of Rama. The court observed that the Hindu claim is 'undisputed' and opined that there is clear evidence that Hindus believed that site to be Rama's birthplace.[72][73]

Terror attack

On 5 July 2005, five Lashkar-e-Taiba's terrorists[74][75] attacked the makeshift Ram temple at the site of destroyed Babri Masjid in Ayodhya, India. All five were shot dead in the ensuing gunfight with the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF), while one civilian died in the grenade attack that the attackers launched in order to breach the cordoned wall. The CRPF suffered three casualties, two of whom were seriously injured with multiple gunshot wounds.

Trust formation and start of construction

The trust was eventually formed under the name of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra. On 5 February 2020, it was announced in the Parliament of India that the government under Prime Minister Narendra Modi had accepted a plan to construct the temple. Two days later, on 7 February, 2.0 hectares (5 acres) of land was allocated for a new mosque to be built 22 km (14 mi) away from Ayodhya city in Dhannipur village.[67][68]

Architecture

The original design for Ram Mandir was devised in 1988 by the Sompura family of Ahmedabad.[3] The Sompuras have contributed to the design of over 100 temples worldwide for at least 15 generations, including the Somnath temple.[27] The chief architect of the temple was Chandrakant Sompura, assisted by his two sons, Nikhil Sompura and Ashish Sompura, who are also architects.[76]

A new design, with some changes from the original, was prepared by the Sompuras in 2020,[76] per the Hindu texts, the Vastu shastra and the Shilpa shastras.[77] The temple will be 250 feet (76 m) wide, 380 feet (120 m) long and 161 feet (49 m) high.[78] Upon completion, the temple complex became the world's third largest Hindu temple.[76] It is designed in the Maru-Gurjara architecture of Nagara style, a type of Hindu temple architecture found primarily in northern India.[27] A model of the proposed temple was showcased during the Prayag Kumbh Mela in 2019.[79]

The temple's main structure has been built on a raised platform with three storeys. It has five *mandapas* in the middle of the *garbhagriha* (sanctum sanctorum) and on the entrance passage. The Shri Ram Darbar, located on the first floor, comprises five halls – Nritya Mandap, Rang Mandap, Sabha Mandap, Prarthana Mandap, and Kirtan Mandap. In Nagara style, the mandapas are decorated with *shikharas*.[24][28]

Adorned with deity statues, the temple includes dedicated mandirs for Surya, Bhagwati, Ganesh, and Shiv at the corners. Annapurna and Hanuman temples are on the northern and southern arms. The foundation features a 14-metre (46 ft)-thick roller-compacted concrete layer resembling artificial rock, with a 21-foot (6.4 m) granite plinth for moisture protection, avoiding iron use. Accessibility is ensured with ramps, lifts, and facilities for the elderly and differently-abled. A pilgrims facility centre for 25,000 people offers medical and locker services. Environmental focus preserves 70% of the 70-acre (28 ha) area as green space, emphasising water conservation.[30][80][81]

The temple has a total of 366 columns. The columns have 16 idols each to include the incarnations of Shiva, the 10 Dashavataras, the Chausath Yoginis, and the 12 incarnations of the goddess Saraswati. The width of the stairs are 16 feet (4.9 m). Per scriptures dedicated to the design of temples dedicated to Vishnu, the sanctum sanctorum is octagonal in shape.[77] According to the temple committee, the site has a capability to handle 70,000 visitors.[82] Larsen & Toubro offered to oversee the design and construction of the temple free of cost, and became the contractor of the project.[83][84] The Central Building Research Institute, National Geophysical Research Institute and the Bombay, Guwahati and Madras IITs have assisted in areas such as soil testing, concrete supply and design.[85][86]

The construction work has been accomplished with 600,000 cubic feet (17,000 m^3) of sandstone from Baansi in Rajasthan.[77] No iron and steel has been used in the construction of the temple, and the fusing of the stone blocks has required ten thousand copper plates.[87] In a culturally significant move, Thailand also symbolically contributed to the inauguration of the Ram Mandir, by sending soil to the Ram Janmabhoomi, building on their prior gesture of sending water from two rivers in Thailand to honour the temple.[88]

According to the temple trust, the final blueprint of Ram Mandir included temples dedicated to Surya, Ganesha, Shiva, Durga, Vishnu and Brahma in the temple grounds.[89]

Fundraising

The Ram Mandir was built with funds gained through international fundraising drives, involving nearly two million volunteers. Ramnath Kovind was the first to contribute, donating ₹500,000 on 14 January 2021, during his tenure as the president of India.[90][91] Over 127 million donations amounting to approximately ₹50 billion were received by the temple.[92][91][93][94] Some media outlets in India claimed that the construction of the Ram mandir was one of the world's biggest crowd funded projects.[95] Fundraising by the Mandir trust has ended on 27 February 2021.[96]

In 2015, the Hindu Mahasabha, among the leading organisation involved in the Ram Mandir issue, alleged the BJP-affiliate Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) of carrying out donation scam of over ₹1,400 crore (US$170 million) over the construction of the temple. The VHP denied this allegation.[97]

In 2019, the national spokesperson of the Nirmohi Akhara, Mahant Sitaram Das, accused the VHP of carrying out a ₹1,400 crore (US$170 million) scam over the temple.[98] Political leaders from opposition parties have also questioned the methods of fund collection.[99][100]

The public were warned of instances in which online scammers posed as fundraisers.[101] The temple has also attracted a number of controversies due to alleged misuse of donation, sidelining of its major activists, and politicisation of the temple by the Bharatiya Janata Party.[98][97][102][103]

Construction

The Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra trust began the first phase of construction of the Ram Mandir in March 2020.[104][105] The COVID-19 pandemic lockdown in India caused a temporary suspension of the construction.[106][107] On 25 March 2020, Ram's idol was moved to a temporary location in the presence of the Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh, Yogi Adityanath.[108] In preparation for the temple's construction, the Vishva Hindu Parishad (VHP) organised a '*Vijay Mahamantra Jaap Anushthan*', in which individuals would gather at different places to chant the 'Vijay Mahamantra' – *Shri Ram, Jai Ram, Jai Jai Ram*, on 6 April 2020. This was said to ensure "victory over hurdles" in constructing the temple.[109]

It was officially announced by Champat Rai, the General Secretary of the Sri Ram Janmbhoomi Kshetra Trust, that 22 January 2024 would be the scheduled date for the installation of the *Ram Lalla* idol in the *garbhagriha* (sanctum sanctorum). On 25 October 2023, a formal invitation was extended to Prime Minister Narendra Modi to attend the ceremony.[110]

In 2020, the national spokesperson of the Nirmohi Akhara, Mahant Sitaram Das, criticised the BJP's decision to have the temple foundation begun by Narendra Modi and said that the work of building the temple should be done only by the religious priests.[103] A number of Hindutva proponents, including online social media influencers, raised objections over the temple's construction with regards to its design and involvement of the Muslims, claiming that they found Islamic motifs in the Ram Mandir. Champat Rai, the general secretary of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra trust, responded to these concerns by saying that temple was being sculpted by experts, and there could be no question about their religion.[111] The vice-president of the Hindu Mahasabha, Pandit Ashok Sharma, said that the BJP "got the entire thing politicised."[102]

A number of opposition parties, as well as BJP members themselves, have criticised the BJP for using the temple to for gain political mileage.[112] The President of the Congress, Mallikarjun Kharge, had questioned the authority of Home Minister Amit Shah, after he declared the opening date of the temple.[113] The BJP leader Subramanian Swamy questioned Prime Minister Narendra Modi's involvement in Ram Mandir's inauguration.[114] The Congress MP Shashi Tharoor has criticised the Indian media for diverting attention from critical governance issues by overly focusing on the temple.[115]

Bhumi Pujan ceremony

On the occasion of Bhumi Pujan, the Ram Lalla's dress was stitched by tailors Bhagwat Prasad and Shankar Lal, a fourth generation tailor to Rama's idol.[116]

The temple construction officially started again after a *Bhumi-Pujan* (transl. ground breaking ceremony) on 5 August 2020. The three-day long Vedic ritual was held ahead of the groundbreaking ceremony, which revolved around the installation of a 40 kg (88 pounds) silver brick as the foundation stone by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.[3] On the day before on 4 August, the *Ramarchan Puja* (transl. Puja of Rama's feet) was performed, in order to ritually invite all the major deities into the temple.[117]

On the occasion of the *Bhoomi Poojan*, soil and holy water were collected from several religious places across India, such as the Triveni Sangam of the rivers Ganga, Yamuna, and Saraswati at Prayagraj, the head of the Kaveri River at Talakaveri in Karnataka, and the Kamakhya Temple in Assam.[118] Soil was

also sent from various Hindu temples, gurudwaras and Jain temples across the nation, as well as from the four pilgrimage sites in Char Dham, to bless the temple.[119]

Prime Minister Narendra Modi performing *Bhumi Pujan* or the groundbreaking ceremony for the Ram Mandir. Also visible are the chief of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), Mohan Bhagwat, and the Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Anandiben Patel.

Before the ceremony, Prime Minister Narendra Modi sought Hanuman's blessing by praying at the Hanuman Garhi Temple in Ayodhya.[120] The Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh, Yogi Adityanath, Chief of Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh, Mohan Bhagwat, Chief of the Ram Janmabhoomi Nyas and Chief of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra, Nritya Gopal Das and Narendra Modi gave speeches.[120]

Some priests and religious leaders, such as Swaroopanand Saraswati, complained that 5 August was not a ritually auspicious date and that the ceremony did not follow proper ritual procedures. They also claimed that the function did not include a havan.[121] Writer and activist Arundhati Roy, a noted critic of PM Modi, pointed out that the chosen date marked one year since the revocation of the special status of Jammu and Kashmir.[53] The Pakistan Foreign Office issued a statement criticising India for commencing for constructing a temple on the former site of the destroyed Babri Masjid.[122]

In 2017, the Hindu Mahasabha accused the BJP, Bajrang Dal and other Sangh Parivar organisations of hijacking the Ram Mandir despite having no involvement in its long battle.[123][102] In 2020, Pramod Joshi, the national spokesperson of the Hindu Mahasabha, said that the real credit of Ram Mandir belongs to Hindu Mahasabha, and that the Hindu Mahasabha should have performed the bhumi pujan, but instead had been kept away. He added that the committee for the temple was formed at the BJP's central office and the Hindu Mahasabha was sidelined.[124]

2021–present

The temple trust decided to launch a nationwide "mass contact and contribution campaign" aimed at reaching 55–600 million people.[86] Voluntary donations of ₹1 (1.2¢ US) and higher were accepted.[125] On 1 January 2021, former President Ram Nath Kovind made the first contribution towards the construction of the Ram Mandir by donating more than ₹5 lakh (US$5,900).[126] Several leaders and notable personalities across the nation followed this. By April 2021, around ₹5,000 crore (US$590 million) was collected from donations across India.[127][128] Nearly 150,000 VHP activists participated in collecting donations. The temple trust also received donations from the members of the Muslim and Christian communities.[129]

In August 2021, a viewing location was created for the public to observe the construction works in the temple site.[130] Following the groundbreaking ceremony, up to 40 feet (12 m) of debris were removed and the remaining earth compacted.[131] The foundation was made using roller-compacted concrete.[132] A total of 47–48 layers, with each layer 1-foot (0.30 m) high, were completed by mid-September 2021.[131][133] Due to electricity supply issues in Mirzapur, the cutting of the sandstone was slowed down.[89] In early 2022, a video was released by the temple trust, showing the planned construction of the temple in 3D along with other related information.[134][135][5]

In January 2023, two 60-million-year-old Shaligram rocks, 26 tonnes and 14 tonnes respectively, were sent from the Gandaki River in Nepal. These rocks were used to carve the idol of *Ram Lalla* in the sanctum sanctorum.[136] In August 2023, according to the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, 70% of the groundwork was completed and 40% of the roof work was completed.[137] In December 2023, the entire base, along with the six smaller temples that surround the main temple, which consists of the sanctum sanctorum, were almost completed.[138] For its consecration, only the ground floor was opened.[139] The temple is expected to be completed by July 2025.[140]

View of the Ram Mandir under construction in 2022

Consecration

On 22 June 2023, Temple Construction Committee chairman Nripendra Misra announced that the ground floor of the three-story temple was complete and was expected to open for the devotees in January 2024.[141] The Ram Mandir Teerth Kshetra Trust announced that Hindu astrologers had selected 22 January 2024 as the auspicious date for the consecration ceremony.[142]

Devotees and visitors celebrating the *Prana Pratishtha* ceremony outside the temple on 22 January 2024

In preparation for the *Prana Pratishtha* (consecration) ceremony, the Government of Uttar Pradesh earmarked ₹100 crore (US$12 million) for 'Ramotsav', a series of religious events that spanned 826 local bodies across Uttar Pradesh along with the *Ram Paduka* Yatra, commencing in December 2023 and culminating in the grand celebrations from Makar Sankranti on 16 January 2024, and lasting until the inauguration of the Ram Mandir on 22 January. The yatra followed the *Ram Van Gaman* Path, retracing Rama's 14-year exile from Ayodhya.[143] The trust, the Government of Uttar Pradesh, and Ayodhya city administrators carried out extensive preparations to accommodate the influx of devotees and invited guests from all over the world.[144] Strict security measures were enacted in and around the temple premises.[145] The Government of Uttar Pradesh announced public holiday to mark the occasion. The Government of India and some state governments declared a half day holiday.[146]

Prime Minister Narendra Modi was invited to perform the Prana Pratishtha of the newly made idol in the sanctum sanctorum.[147] In preparation, he undertook an 11-day fast, consuming only coconut water and fruit and sleeping on the ground at night.[148] He performed the consecration ceremony on 22 January 2024 from 12:15 PM to 12:45PM IST.[149] Prime Minister Modi urged every Indian to light up *diyas* to mark the occasion and celebrate it like Diwali.[150]

The guests were addressed by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, RSS Chief Mohan Bhagwat and Prime Minister Modi.[151][152] Modi also spoke of Rama as a symbol of righteousness and unity.[153]

While Yogi Adityanath's address was steeped in religious fervor, celebrating the Ram Mandir as a victory for faith and perseverance. He praised the devotion of millions who contributed to the temple's construction and acknowledged the divine blessings that guided the process.[154][155]

Prime Minister Modi during Prana Pratishtha

Mohan Bhagwat spoke of the Ram Mandir as a symbol of national pride, marking the revival of India's cultural heritage. He emphasised the importance of preserving ancient traditions and values in a rapidly modernising world.[156]

The guest list also included prominent industrialists, scientists, actors, army officers, spiritual leaders and Padma awardees.[157][158] The event was organised by Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra.[159]

None of the four Shankaracharyas of the four cardinal mathas, citing various reasons, took part in the ceremony.[160][161][162] Sringeri Sharada Peetham issued a denial that its head seer Bharathi Tirtha had expressed some displeasure and called the ceremony a "matter of joy" for all Hindu believers.[163] Tirtha blessed the event and sent an administrative officer, Gowrishankar as representative of the matha.[164] The head seer of Govardhan Math, Nischalananda Saraswati said that the ceremony deviated from established tradition.[165] The head seer of Jyotir Math, Swami Avimukteshwaranand has stated that the ceremony is against Hindu sastras as the temple is still under construction.[166][167] The head seer of the Dwarka Sharada Peetham, Swami Sadanand Saraswati welcomed the ceremony as a "long-awaited moment".[168] He said that none of the four Shankaracharyas were angry and that it was not appropriate for them to attend given, the massive crowd expected.[169]

On 25 November 2025, the temple construction was formally completed with an event called *Ram Mandir Dhwajarohan* marked by hoisting of the saffron flag, *Dharma Dhwaja*, atop the temple by PM Modi.[14] The ceremony took place on the auspicious day of Vivah Panchami, with the flag, featuring the Sun, ‘Om’, and the Kovidara tree.[14] The dignitaries at the event included RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat, Governor Anandiben Patel, and Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath.[14]

Impact and associated activities

The temple construction has been accompanied by a $10 billion transformation plan for Ayodhya,[a] "encompassing a new airport, revamped railway station, and township development", fostering multiple hotel development projects and stimulating various economic activities.[172][173] As Hindu devotees all over the world throng to have a *darśana* (auspicious viewing) of this deity, the subsequent economic impact has been estimated to further enrich the state by the end of the year 2024 by four trillion Indian rupees (equivalent to 48 billion US dollars).[174]

Given its religious significance among Hindus, it is estimated that with 50 million annual visitors, Ayodhya's Ram temple is likely to become the most visited Hindu pilgrimage site in India.[175] After the opening of the Ram Temple to public on 23 January 2024, Ayodhya has welcomed 2.4 million visitors in just 12 days.[176] Based on the current visitor numbers, the Ayodhya's Ram temple is projected to become one of the most visited pilgrimage sites in the world, surpassing Mecca and the Vatican.[177] Given the

temple rush by devotees from all parts of India, it was estimated that spiritual tourism at Ayodhya has potential to create thousands of jobs as more manpower is required to cater the needs of the Ram mandir visitors and also attract huge investments.[178][179]

A 9.8-metre (32 ft) model of Ram Mandir displayed during Diwali of 2020 at Pacific Mall in West Delhi[170][171]

On April 17, 2024, the first Ram Navami (Ram's birth) festival after the consecration of the Ram Temple was celebrated by thousands of devotees.[180] On this occasion, the *Ram Temple* witnessed a unique event at noon as the forehead of the Ram Lalla idol was anointed with a ray of sunlight, known as *Sūrya Tilaka* (transl. Sun tilak).[181] As the sun rays illuminated the forehead of the Lord *Ram Lalla* idol, scores of devotees celebrated the event.[180] The development of the *Sūrya Tilaka* mechanism involved collaboration between scientists from *Central Building Research Institute (CBRI)*, Roorkee, and the *Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIAP)*, Bangalore, who devised a sophisticated apparatus consisting of mirrors and lenses to direct a beam of light to the deity's forehead, marking a significant scientific feat.[181][180]

In popular culture

During the 2021 Republic Day parade on Rajpath, Uttar Pradesh's tableau showcased a replica of the Ram Mandir.[182] In October 2023, Durga Puja celebrations in Santosh Mitra Square, Kolkata exhibited a replica of Ram Mandir, along with other notable buildings around the world.[183][184]

Uttar Pradesh tableau in the Republic Day parade of 2021

Slogans

Maṁdira vahīṁ banāēṁgē (transl. The temple will be built exactly there) is an expression in Hindi, and has become one of the most popular slogans concerning the Ram Janmabhoomi movement and the Ram Mandir. It has been used as early as 1985–86, was popularised in the 1990s, and has several variations.[185][186]

It has been a symbol of hope and it has become a part of festivities, and has also become a part of stand-up comedy, jokes and memes.[187][188] In 2019, the slogan was used in the Parliament of India,[187] and it has also been used by media houses.[189][190] The slogan has been used as a threat as well as a vow.[191]

There are variations of the slogan such as one used by Lal Krishna Advani: "*Saugaṁdha Rāma kī khātē haiṁ, hama maṁdira vahīṁ banāēṁgē*" (transl. We take a vow of Rama that we will build the temple exactly there).[185] Other variations and adaptations include "*Vahīṁ banēgā maṁdira*" (transl. A temple will be built there),[189] "*Jahāṁ Rāma kā janma huā thā, hama maṁdira vahīṁ banāēṁgē*" (transl. The temple will be built where Rama was born),[186] "*Rāmā Lallā hama āēṁgē, maṁdira vahīṁ banāēṁgē*"

(transl. Ram Lalla, we will come, the temple will be built there, *or* Ram Lalla we will come to construct a Mandir exactly there)[186] and "*Pahalē maṁdira, phira sarakāra*" (transl. First the temple, then the government).[192]

Books

- *The Battle for Rama: Case of the Temple at Ayodhya* by Meenakshi Jain, ISBN 9788173055799, 8173055793
- *Sunrise over Ayodhya: Nationhood in Our Times* by Salman Khurshid, ISBN 9789354923050, 9354923054

Films

- *Mission Ayodhya* directed by Sameer Ramesh Surve[193]

See also

- Hindu pilgrimage sites in India
- Hindu pilgrimage sites of world
- List of Hindu festivals
- Rama Navami festival
- Tourism in India
- Devashila Yatra
- Ramnam Bank

Notes

a. Not to be confused with Ayodhya (Ramayana)
b. Chandrakant Sompura[2]
Nikhil Sompura and Ashish Sompura[3]
c. The avatars of Vishnu are of two types. *Pūrṇā* and *Amśa* (lit. 'A part'). In the former, Vishnu himself was supposed to have descended on Earth from his abode while in the latter, an equivalent part (or a copy) of him was sent to take the incarnation. Nrisimha, Rama and Krishna are said to be the Purnavataras of Vishnu.[31]
d. As per Valmiki Ramayana, Rama had sixteen qualities. Rama was said to be *1.**guṇavān**, 2.**vīryavān**, 3.**dharmajñaḥ**, 4.**kṛtajñaḥ**, 5.**satyavākyaḥ**, 6.**dṛḍhavrataḥ**, 7.**cāritraḥ**, 8.**sarvabhūteṣu hitaḥ**, 9.**vidvān**, 10.**samarthaḥ**, 11. **priyadarśanaḥ**, 12.**ātmavān**, 13.**jitakrodhaḥ**, 14.**dyutimān**, 15. **anasūyakaḥ**, and 16.**jātaroṣasya saṃyuge devāśca bibhyati**.*
e. The presiding deity is also referred by other names such as *Acala mūrti* (lit. Immovable idol), *Dhṛva mūrti*(lit. Fixed idol) and *Mūlavigraha* (lit. The main idol).[40][41]

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